was mythologized in the famous Jodha–Akbar movie of 2008, the legend proving a great deal more enduring than gritty reality.

From Allahabad Salim then continued his attempts to reconcile with his father, exploring the idea of presenting himself at court. But Akbar remained unconvinced of the sincerity of the prince and decided to send for someone whose counsel and loyalty was beyond reproach. Abu'l Fazl was given orders to proceed to the court at Agra immediately, leaving his soldiers with his son in the Deccan. Responding to the Padshah's summons, Abu'l Fazl began to make his journey north with a small retinue but his path, from the Deccan to Agra, was to lead him through Bundelkhand, the territory of a certain 'highway robber' who had been waiting for ten years to challenge the cards that fate had dealt him.

---

*Khusrau was their son-in-law and nephew, respectively.

*An inscription or sentence in which certain letters refer to a particular date.

†A large section of the album is today in the Golestan Palace Library, Tehran.

*I am grateful to Professor Kavita Singh for bringing this to my attention.